GLOBALIZATION AND THE SOVEREIGNTY OF THE STATE

The Westphalian model of state system has come under the threats of globalization. Though the states, still surviving, exercise their power and authority in certain respects, but the core of the Westphalian model, that is, the concept of sovereignty, has been deeply undermined in a fast globalizing world. The concept of sovereignty pertains to a specific reference, to a specific territory where governments exercise absolute authority. But the forces of globalization have rendered the territorial limits useless. In other words, there has been a deterritorialization of the world.

The state in a globalizing world has to work along with the forces which are not under its control even such as surveillance by global governance agencies, nationalism, global ecological problems, satellite communications, electronic money transfers, multinational companies, migration, information flows, technology transfers and, most importantly, nuclear weapons and weapons of mass destruction. Scholars point out that the concept of absolute sovereignty was developed under conditions of relatively low level of interdependence among the states. However, the complex level of interdependence with large flow of capital, labour, technology and information across border has now emerged within the changing patterns of sovereignty and its meaning and conditionality are continuously changing in a fast globalizing world.

The suprastate global governance system has also limited the state sovereignty. In several fields, ranging from macroeconomic policy, conflict management, to human rights and environmental movements more than the state it is now the suprastate agencies such as the United Nations, the IMF, the WTO, the World Bank, and various regional arrangements have significant roles to play.

Global social movements have also now come to undermine the sovereignty of states. These movements on various social, political, economic issues or even ecological issues exploit the benefits of globalization, that is, fast travel and communication, the Internet, developments in telecommunication, awareness about global laws help to conduct transborder social movements which pervade the